

Assignment Brief: Growth Strategy for a Decentralized ID & Payments Protocol



Company: **Portal Technologies Inc**

Challenge: **Accelerate adoption of our open-source ID/payments protocol and mobile app.**

What is Portal?

Portal manages your digital identity (aka public key) and centralizes the approval of payments and subscription in a single app: you can authorize passwordless logins, single or recurring payments and even produce zero-knowledge proofs of your real documents (passport, drivers license) when a service requires them.

Portal is just a client of the (still unnamed) FOSS protocol we are designing. It's fully decentralized and doesn't lock users in.

Hence we can see Portal as "just" the graphic interface. Which lets the user access in a friendly way all the things that the "unnamed" protocol offers.

Portal is a proxy, you connect your wallet or bank account (in the future) and the mobile app will abstract all the complexity from the user: when you approve a payment in the app it's automatically taken from the wallet you connected. Any NWC (Nostr Wallet Connect) compatible wallet can be linked to Portal.

What Portal isn't?

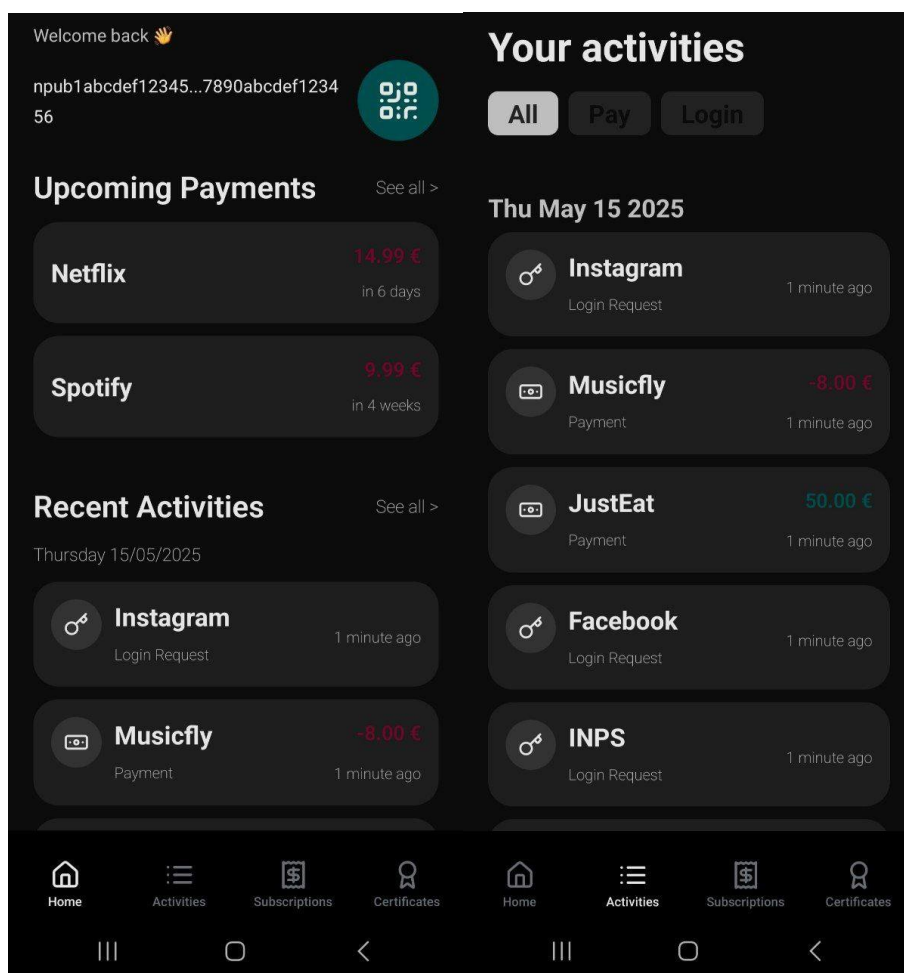
- Portal is NOT the protocol that leverages Nostr and Bitcoin.
- Portal is NOT a wallet (both LN and Onchain).
- Portal is NOT just for bitcoiners, quite the opposite.
- Portal is NOT a KYC platform (identities are just Nostr private/public keys)
- Portal is NOT an hardware device (the HW will play a small role in this product)
- Portal is NOT a government entity :)

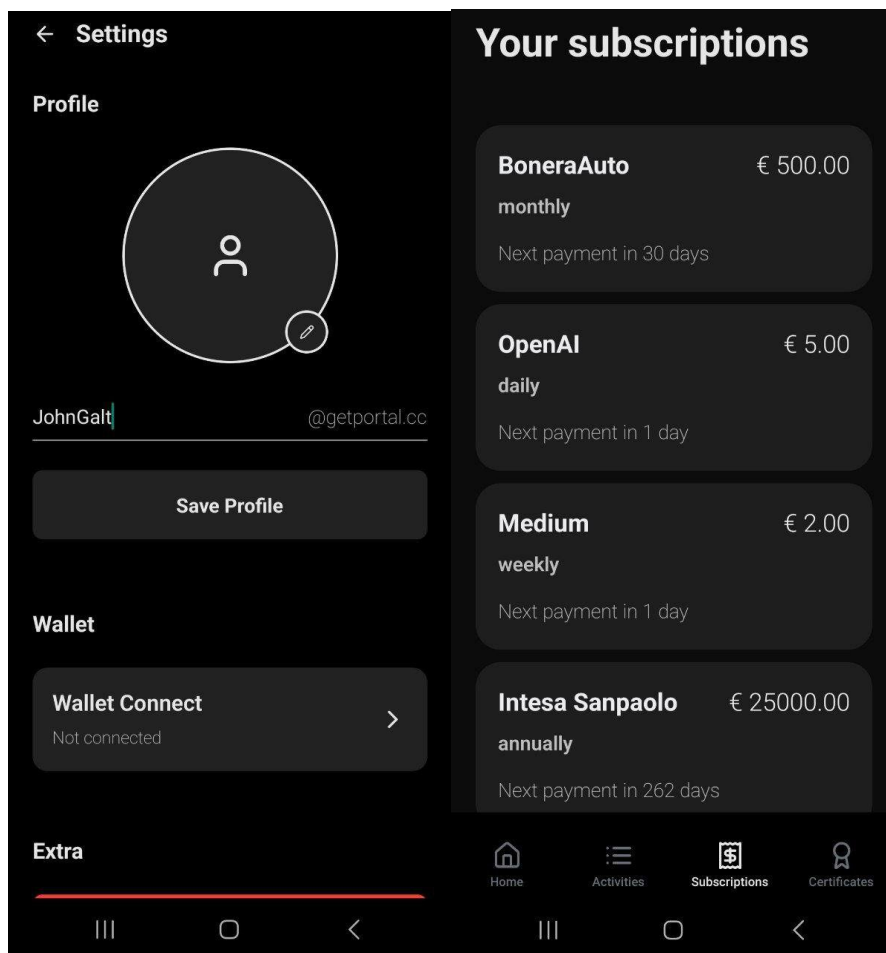
How are we envisioning Portal?

We want Portal to be the app for approving sensitive operations. Portal can be used to authenticate and make payments online as well as in person, for example as a badge to authenticate to a machine.

The UX/UI will be the smoothest possible: because this product is aimed at the normie, not the ultra cypherpunk bitcoiner. Normies don't want to know about the tech powering their products, they want smoothness and ease of use. Can't blame them.

Here some screens from the app:





We are also releasing an open source SDK to help companies adopt our protocol: through our free SDK they can authenticate users, get paid and request to see ZK proofs of the user's real ID. This allows companies to completely bypass costly payment and KYC processors, while also removing any central point of failures since they will only depend on a decentralized protocol.

The Problem

We've built a decentralized identity and payments protocol based on Nostr and LN (think "the internet but for identities", a protocol that every machine will speak, and embeds payments and identity together). Our product is a mobile app with a freemium model (subscription unlocks extra features). Since the protocol is free and open source we are leveraging the first mover advantage and we are building the first "client" of this protocol with this mobile app.

The hardest part is bootstrapping the adoption feedback loop: as long as no services support our protocol, no user will download the app. At the same time, as long as we don't have users, there's no reason for services to adopt the protocol.

Your Task

Develop a 12-month strategy to:

- **Acquire users (Who's the ideal early adopter? How do we reach them?)**
- **Incentivize ecosystem development (How do we attract developers/partners?)**
- **Kickstart the snowball effect**

Balance open-source values with sustainability (Beyond subscriptions, what revenue streams could work?)

In your strategy include a rough budget (e.g for marketing expenses) and a rough timeline as well (which nice should we leverage first, how many months will it take to expand outside that nice, etc).

Final assignment:

A 5-8 slides pitch deck OR 2/3-page report (PDF) with:

- Target user segments + acquisition tactics (e.g., referral programs).
- Partnership ideas (e.g., companies, fintechs, nation states).
- Rough cost estimates & timeline (e.g., "Hackathon: \$1k, social media adv 5k").
- Biggest risks (e.g., regulation, competition) and how to mitigate them.

Good luck to everyone :)

Here all the useful links you may need:

- [X](#)
- [GitHub](#)
- [Website](#)
- [@N_sats](#) on Telegram. Feel free to text me anytime, we're here to support you guys :).